laserdata

Prepared for **Pinterest**

Real-time in-flight spend for Pinterest ad budgets, on LaserData.

Every ad insertion's spend reaches **every ad server's budget view in milliseconds**, so ad groups stop at their daily budget instead of serving free ads. It runs beside Kafka, so nothing else has to move.

One ad group at its budget,
two ad servers, one auction.
Now multiply by every ad group.




```
19:42:07.214   insertion   ag-0418833  ads-031  in-flight $0.12  day $99.93 of $100
19:42:07.220   applied     in every ad server's budget view  +6 ms
19:42:07.530   auction     ads-118  ag-0418833 is a candidate
19:42:07.531   budget held ag-0418833 sits out, the slot goes to the next ad
```

From the creators of APACHE IGGY

15×
faster P99 latency
than Apache Kafka

4×
higher throughput
than Apache Kafka

60–70%
lower infrastructure cost
compute, storage and network

Apache Iggy vs Apache Kafka, LaserData testing. Results vary by workload.

What you shared	In-flight spend goes to **"thousands of ads servers"**, because **"overdelivery occurs when free ads are shown for out-of-budget advertisers."** The rule: actual plus in-flight spend over the daily budget, don't show. (Pinterest Engineering)
Where it fits	**The in-flight spend lane:** every insertion's spend, keyed by ad group, to every ad server's budget view, counted once by event ID. Kafka, the spend system and billing stay.
Next	**AI agents** act on the same lane, with session, context, memory and replay from Laser SDK.
Underneath	**One durable event log.** LaserData, powered by Apache Iggy.

Try it in 15 minutes. Let the numbers decide.

A ready-made kit for Pinterest: **3 ad servers, 20,000 ad groups with daily budgets**, Pinterest's in-flight spend formula, repeated events, insertion logs next door, a restart and a Kafka shadow bridge. It prints the lane's p99 every second and overdelivery every budget day.

Open the Pinterest kit and write-up →

Then a 2–4 week evaluation on a mirror of your ad insertions, alongside Kafka. **No advantage, no migration.**

kranti@laserdata.com laserdata.com

© 2026 LaserData, Inc. Apache, Apache Iggy and the Iggy logo are trademarks of The Apache Software Foundation; their use does not imply endorsement by the ASF. The Pinterest name identifies the intended reader only; no affiliation is implied. Facts are from the Pinterest Engineering blog posts "Using Kafka Streams API for predictive budgeting" (2017) and "Flexible Daily Budgeting at Pinterest" (2022); Pinterest has not published whether the 2017 design is still in use. Ad group, ad servers, amounts, timestamps and the 5-second lag are illustrative.